

- **-P** performs a secure delete. The file's location on the hard drive is written over and erased three times so that nothing, not even Data Recovery software will know what was there.

### 9.3.5 echo

If you are not sure about the contents of the directory you are going to delete, you can make the **rm** less risky by prefacing it with the **echo** command. It makes terminal show the command a second time with a list of exactly what you're about to delete. If you've used wildcards, you'll see the names of the files that will be selected by the **\*** character. Once you've reviewed the list and approved what Terminal is about to do, you can retype the command without the echo portion to carry out the function.

#### Note

**rm** doesn't work on file or directory names that begin with a hyphen (-). To delete these items, you have to preface their names with a dot slash (/), like this: **rm ./-test.doc**.

## 9.4 Other useful Unix utilities

So far, you've read about only a handful of the hundreds of Unix programs built into Mac OS X and ready to run. Yes, **ls** and **sudo** are very useful commands, but they're just the beginning. Here's a rundown of some more useful programs that await your experimentation.



```

Terminal — bash — 80x24
last login: Fri Jan 2 14:03:42 on console
relabos-mac-pro:~ MacAdmin$ ls
desktop                Music
documents              Pictures
downloads              Public
library                Send Registration... or NOT
movies                 Sites
relabos-mac-pro:~ MacAdmin$ cd D
desktop/ Documents/ Downloads/
relabos-mac-pro:~ MacAdmin$ cd Documents/
relabos-mac-pro:Documents MacAdmin$ echo rm *
rm About Stacks.pdf
relabos-mac-pro:Documents MacAdmin$
  
```

Check with echo before using **rm**

such as  $2+4$ , or  $92+96$ , or  $(2*2)+165-95*(2.5/1.2)$ , and then press [Enter]. **Bc** will instantly display the result of your calculation. For more **bc** tips and tricks, you can type **man bc** at the prompt.

### 9.4.1 bc

Unix comes with its own calculator application. When you type **bc** and press [Enter], you get a copyright notice. Once you accept it, you can just type the equation you want to solve,